

RSF — Project 4 Recommendations: A 90-Day Fundraising Roadmap

An internal working presentation for Reggie Stephens and Dominic — sequenced by what's actually open, built for a two-person team, and designed to outlast this externship.

INTERNAL USE ONLY

90-DAY ACTION PLAN

THE STAKES

RSF sits on a real fundraising advantage right now — and the next 90 days decide whether it compounds or closes.

What RSF Has Already Built

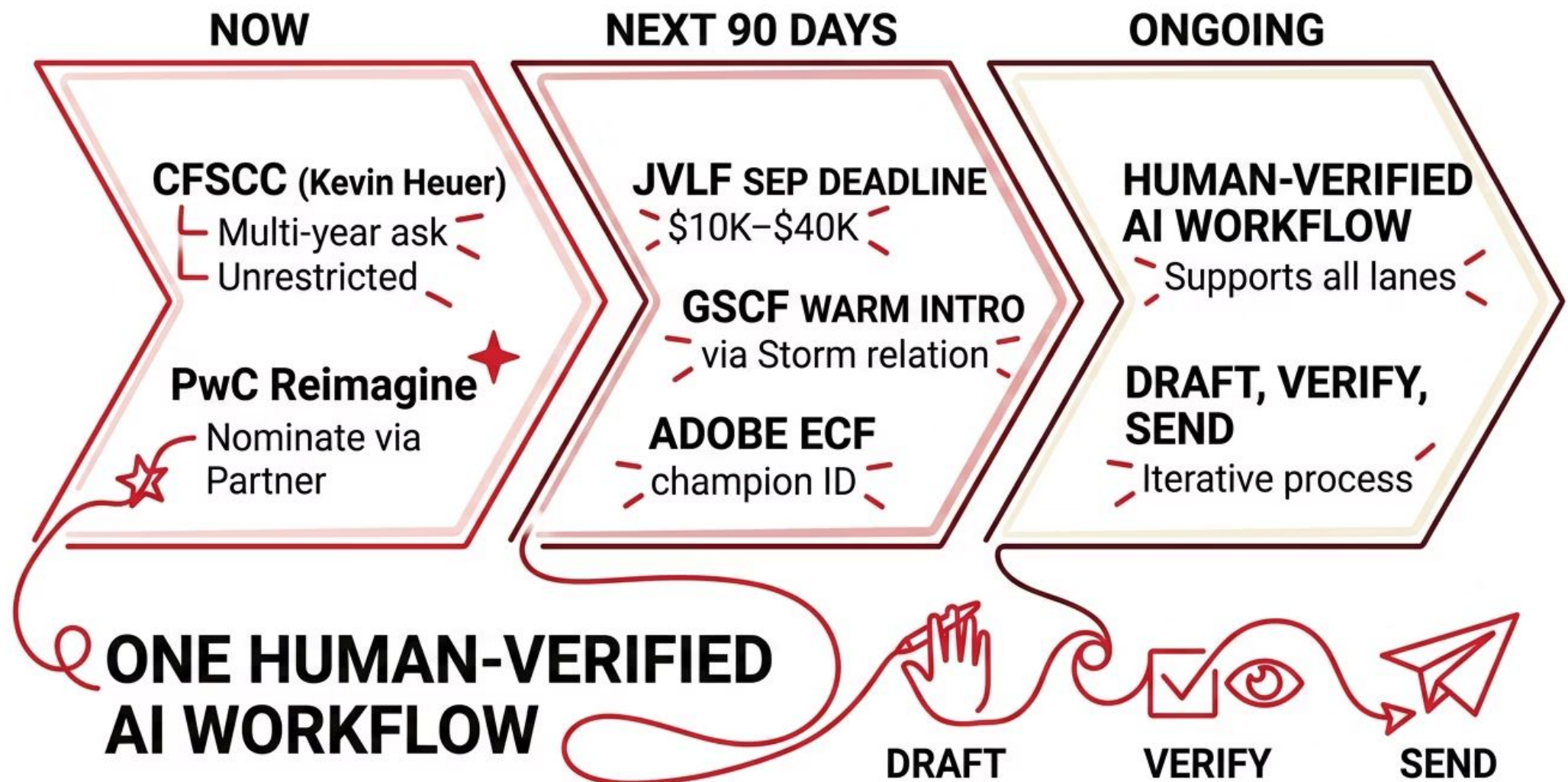
16 named college placements — UC Berkeley, Morgan State, and beyond. **250+ kids per year** served across Sports, Arts, Education, and Culture. Three memorial scholarships bearing real names. That's not potential — that's a track record.

The Timing Hook

The Golden State Storm affiliation and women's flag football momentum put RSF in a position its peers can't easily replicate. Two of the five funding doors ahead won't stay open on their own — they require action in the next 30 days.

Peers haven't caught up yet. That gap is the window.

Close two open doors in 30 days. Build three harder ones by day 90. Run both through one AI workflow that outlasts the externship.



Everything after this slide is evidence for the structure above. The AI workflow isn't a separate workstream — it's the connective tissue running underneath both near-term asks and the cultivation pipeline.

RSF's outcomes already rival top peers — its fundraising engine hasn't caught up yet.

RSF's Proof Points

- **16 named alumni** placed at colleges including UC Berkeley and Morgan State
- **3 memorial scholarships** awarded
- **250+ kids/year** served
- One active corporate sponsor: Driscoll's via Benevity
- Media partnership for reach — not yet revenue

The Peer Standard

- **ACCESS U:** 100% grad rate, 320+ athletes, \$2M+ tuition offset — metrics-led, tiered "Support-a-Player" model
- **BGCSCC:** Corporate diversification across banks, healthcare, and grocery — beyond a single sponsor category
- **First Tee LA:** 2016–2020 revenue drop = the cautionary case for over-relying on a narrow channel set

RSF's Engine Gap

- No donor CRM
- No recurring-giving program
- Single corporate sponsor concentration risk
- Media partnership not yet converted to revenue

❏ The gap isn't outcomes — it's infrastructure.

Nonprofit fundraising is only starting to use AI seriously — and none of RSF's direct peers have started at all.

The AI Adoption Curve in Nonprofit Fundraising

Type 1 — Predictions

Sector commentary about what AI *could* do. No workflow, no result.

Type 2 — Cautionary Tales

Stories of orgs that sent AI-generated outreach without verifying — and damaged relationships.

Type 3 — Verified Workflows

Specific, human-in-the-loop processes with a measured result. This is where RSF is headed.

What RSF's Comp Set Shows

BGCSCC, First Tee LA, and ACCESS U show **no evidence of deliberate AI adoption in fundraising**. RSF has a first-mover window.

The Early-Mover Lesson

The organizations getting real value are using AI to **accelerate research and first-draft writing** — with a human verifying and framing before anything goes out. That's the model. Not automation. Acceleration.

Five vetted partnership leads — sequenced by what's actually open, not by long-term rank.

Partner	Status	Ask / Range	Key Detail
CFSCC	Open now — no deadline	Expanded multi-year unrestricted gift	Contact: Kevin Heuer. Relationship is warm. Reopen the conversation now.
PwC Reimagine	Open now — no deadline	Nomination through supervising partner	Supervising partner already attached to this externship. Internal path exists.
JVLF Fall Cycle	September deadline	\$10K–\$40K	First-time-applicant friendly. Submit before the window closes.
Golden State Community Foundation	Needs cultivation	Invitation-only grant	Warm intro via Storm relationship. Earn the invitation — don't apply for one.
Adobe ECF	Needs cultivation	March–May 2027 window	Window closed this cycle. Identify an employee nominator now to be ready.

Watch item from the broader shortlist: **NFL Foundation Player Matching Grants** — currently closed, non-rolling, next deadline September 30, 2026. Not one of the five active asks, but worth tracking.

The realistic AI move for a two-person team: human-verified drafting support, piloted on the two asks moving first.

The Failure Mode to Avoid

Asking AI for a prospect list and sending outreach without verifying alignment. The Prospects tracker itself is the counter-example: every lead has a **named contact** and a **sourced giving range** — not a generic AI output. Verification isn't optional. It's the whole model.

The Concrete First Move

Use AI to draft first-pass language for the **CFSCC ask** and the **PwC Reimagine nomination** — the two moves already happening in the next 30 days. Reggie and Dominic verify tone and relationship nuance before anything sends.

What Stays Fully Human

- Relationship judgment
- Tone-matching per funder
- The entire Golden State Community Foundation approach

Thirty, sixty, ninety days — and a repeatable workflow, not a one-time push.

0–30 Days

- CFSCC ask reopened with Kevin Heuer
- PwC Reimagine nomination requested via supervising partner
- AI-drafting pilot running on both asks

6-Month Picture

- At least one gift closed
- One competitive decision back
- Two leads warmed for their next cycle
- One AI workflow RSF owns — no extern required

30–90 Days

- JVLF application submitted before September deadline
- Golden State Community Foundation warm intro requested via Storm relationship
- Adobe ECF employee champion identified

❏ The goal isn't a sprint — it's a system. Build the workflow now so RSF can run it independently at month seven, month twelve, and beyond.